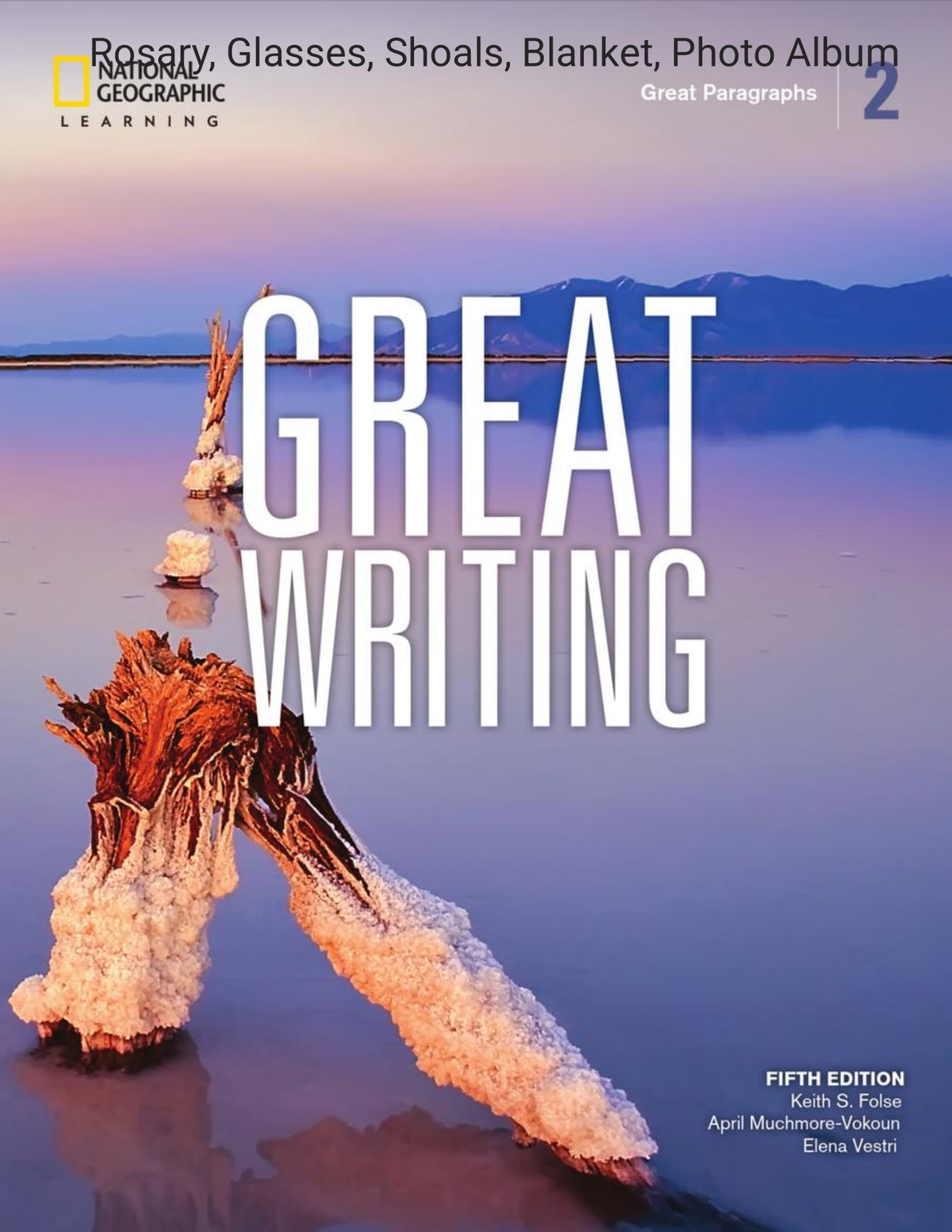
Rosary, Glasses, Shoals, Blanket, Photo Album

NATIONAL GEOGRAPHIC LEARNING

Great Paragraphs | 2

GREAT WRITING



FIFTH EDITION

Keith S. Folse
April Muchmore-Vokoun
Elena Vestri

Great Paragraphs 2

GREAT WRITING

FIFTH EDITION

Keith S. Folse
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NATIONAL GEOGRAPHIC LEARNING

Australia • Brazil • Mexico • Singapore • United Kingdom • United States

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Copacabana beach and cityscape seen from Sugarloaf Mountain at dusk, Rio de Janeiro, Brazil

FREEWRITE

Look at the photo. What can you say about the geography around Rio de Janeiro and the types of activities people might enjoy? Write five to ten sentences.



Statue of Simón Bolivar in Mompox, Colombia

PARAGRAPH 1.6

Simón Bolívar

Simón Bolívar (1783–1830) was one of South America's greatest heroes and a very **powerful** man. In Spanish, Simón Bolívar is often called *El Libertador*, which means "The Liberator[1]." Spanish is the national language in at least 22 countries. This name is a very good one because he helped six countries become independent from Spain: Bolivia (1809), Colombia (1819), Ecuador (1820), Panama (1821), Peru (1821), and his home country of Venezuela (1811). In fact, Bolivia is named for Bolívar. Not many people have countries named after them. Because these six countries together are **approximately** the same size as modern Europe, their independence was an important event in history. Although Bolívar's name is not as well-known outside Latin America, many people there believe that he is the most important person in their history.

[1]liberator: someone who helps others become free

1. What is the main idea of the paragraph? _____

_____

2. Does the paragraph have a topic sentence? If so, write it here. If not, write one here.

_____

3. Are all the sentences related to the topic? _____ If not, cross out the unrelated sentence(s).

4. What is the concluding sentence? Write it here.

_____

_____

Mechanics: Capitalization and End Punctuation

A **capital letter** indicates that the word is at the beginning of a sentence or is a name. Names are given to a specific person (**D**r. **J**enkins), a place (**J**apan), a company (**S**wiss **A**irlines), and a variety of other things (**H**ello **K**itty, the **U**nited **N**ations,...).

End punctuation includes periods (.), question marks (?), and exclamation marks (!).

For more information, see "Capitalization and Punctuation" in the *Writer's Handbook*.

ACTIVITY 10 | Editing capitalization and end punctuation

Each sentence has (x) number of errors. Find and correct them.

1. the geography of turkey is unique. (3)
2. most countries are on one continent, but turkey lies in both asia and Europe (4)
3. the asian part of the Country is much larger than the european part (5)
4. two european countries that border turkey are bulgaria and Greece (5)
5. turkey has coasts on the mediterranean sea and the black sea. (5)
6. half of it's land is higher than 1,000 meters above sea level (3)
7. in fact, two-thirds of the country is higher than 800 meters above sea level (2)
8. the geography is one reason millions of tourists visit this country every year (2)

ACTIVITY 11 | Copying a paragraph

On a separate piece of paper, write the corrected sentences from Activity 10 in paragraph form. Do not change the order. Make sure you indent your paragraph and correct all errors in capitalization and end punctuation. Write a title on the top line.



The Bosphorus Bridge in Istanbul, Turkey, connects Asia and Europe.

Grammar: Subject-Verb Agreement in the Simple Present

EXPLANATION	EXAMPLES
Make sure the verb form matches the subject in number. If the subject is singular, the verb should be singular. If the subject is plural, the verb should be plural. Remember to use the *-s* form of the verb with *he, she,* and *it.*	Singular: A good stud[redacted]ew words every day. Plural: Good studer[redacted]new words every day.
Prepositional phrases include a preposition (*at, for, by, with, without, in, of,* and so on.) + an object of the preposition (a noun, noun phrase, pronoun). The object of a preposition is never the subject.	The main **products** of Brazil and Colombia **are** coffee and aluminum. [redacted] coffee.
The noun after *there is* or *there are* is the subject of the sentence.	There **is a dictionary** on the table. There **are three reasons** for this decision.
Pronouns wit[redacted] Nouns wit[redacted]ular.	**Everyone has** an accent of some kind. **Every** student **needs** a book and a workbook.
Gerunds (*-ing* words used as a noun) are always singular.	**Drinking** milk **is** good for your body. **Drinking** milk and juice **is** good for your body.

ACTIVITY 12 | Editing subject-verb agreement errors

Read the sentences. If the sentence is correct, write *C*. If it is incorrect, write *I* and correct it. There are six sentences with errors.

1. I The main method of transportation in these five islands ~~are~~ is the public bus system.
2. C Everybody prefers to live near the ocean because it is less dry.
3. I The trees behind the new high school ~~is~~ are very tall.
4. C Earth revolves around the sun.
5. I According to the new rules, a pilot and a copilot flies this type of large plane.
6. I The three baby elephants at the zoo weighs just under 300 pounds.
7. C There are many interesting things to do in San Francisco.
8. I Each player on both teams need the ability to run very fast.
9. C Laughing with friends is a healthy way to spend time.
10. I Everyone with five correct answers get a passing grade.

ACTIVITY 13 | Practicing subject-verb agreement

Choose the correct verb form in each sentence.

1. One reason many people want to visit Asia **(/ are)** to see Japan.
2. In many people's opinions, the best places to visit in Japan **(is /** Tokyo and Kyoto.
3. Tokyo **(/ are)** a very modern city with many tall buildings.
4. In fact, the skyscrapers in Tokyo **(is /** some of the tallest buildings in the world.
5. However, the city skyline **(do /** not look like the scenery in Kyoto at all.
6. Life in Kyoto **(move /** more slowly than life in Tokyo.
7. Kyoto **(/ are)** not only smaller but also much older.
8. Kyoto **(was / were)** the capital of Japan a long time ago.
9. There **(is / are)** still many historic buildings in Kyoto, so tourists can see them all over the city.
10. Life in these two places **(is / are)** quite different, and tourists **(visit / visits)** each city for very different reasons.

ACTIVITY 14 | Copying a paragraph

Copy the sentences from Activity 13 in the same order on a separate piece of paper. Make sure your paragraph is indented. Write a title.



Shibuya Crossing in Tokyo, Japan


Zaka Street in Kyoto, Japan

ACTIVITY 15 | Correcting subject-verb agreement errors

Read the paragraph. It has seven errors in subject-verb agreement. Cross out each error and write the correct form above it.

WORDS TO KNOW Paragraph 1.7

a great deal (of): (phr) a lot of; a large amount
extremely: (adv) very
patient: (adj) calm; having the ability to wait calmly

PARAGRAPH 1.7

The Hard Work of a Kindergarten Teacher

Some people think that Mira Ahmed has an easy job, but teaching a class of 22 very young children are not easy. Mira is a kindergarten teacher. Class begins at 8:00 a.m., but [redacted] arrive by 7:30. Before class, [redacted] set up the room for her students. The students arrive between 7:45 and 8:00, and then the class begins. The young [redacted] in her class keeps her **extremely** busy for the rest of the day. They play games and learn new things. However, there is always a few small problems. Sometimes [redacted] runs around the room or cry, but Mira tries to be very **patient** with all of her students. After school, she attends meetings and prepare lessons for the next day. Mira says she loves her job, but it really is **a great deal** of work.



Young students take part in classes at a primary school in Abu Dhabi, UAE.

5. (take care of/problem) _____

_____

6. (require/credit card) _____

_____

Combining Sentences

Some writers like to keep their sentences short. They believe they will make mistakes if they write longer, more difficult sentences. However, longer sentences connect ideas, and this makes it easier for the reader to understand. The most important information from each sentence can be used to create longer and smoother sentences.

A word or word form may change or be omitted, but no ideas are changed or omitted. Remember that there is usually more than one way to combine sentences. Study these sentences. The important information is circled.

There was a (storm) (yesterday).

It was (strong).

It moved (quickly) (toward the city).

Now read these longer, smoother sentences:

Yesterday, a strong storm moved quickly toward the city.

There was a strong storm that moved quickly toward the city yesterday.

ACTIVITY 22 | Combining sentences

Combine the ideas into one sentence. You may change the word forms, but do not change or omit any ideas. There may be more than one answer.

1. The weather was extremely cold yesterday.
   A majority of the flights departed late.
   The flights were from Boston.

   _____

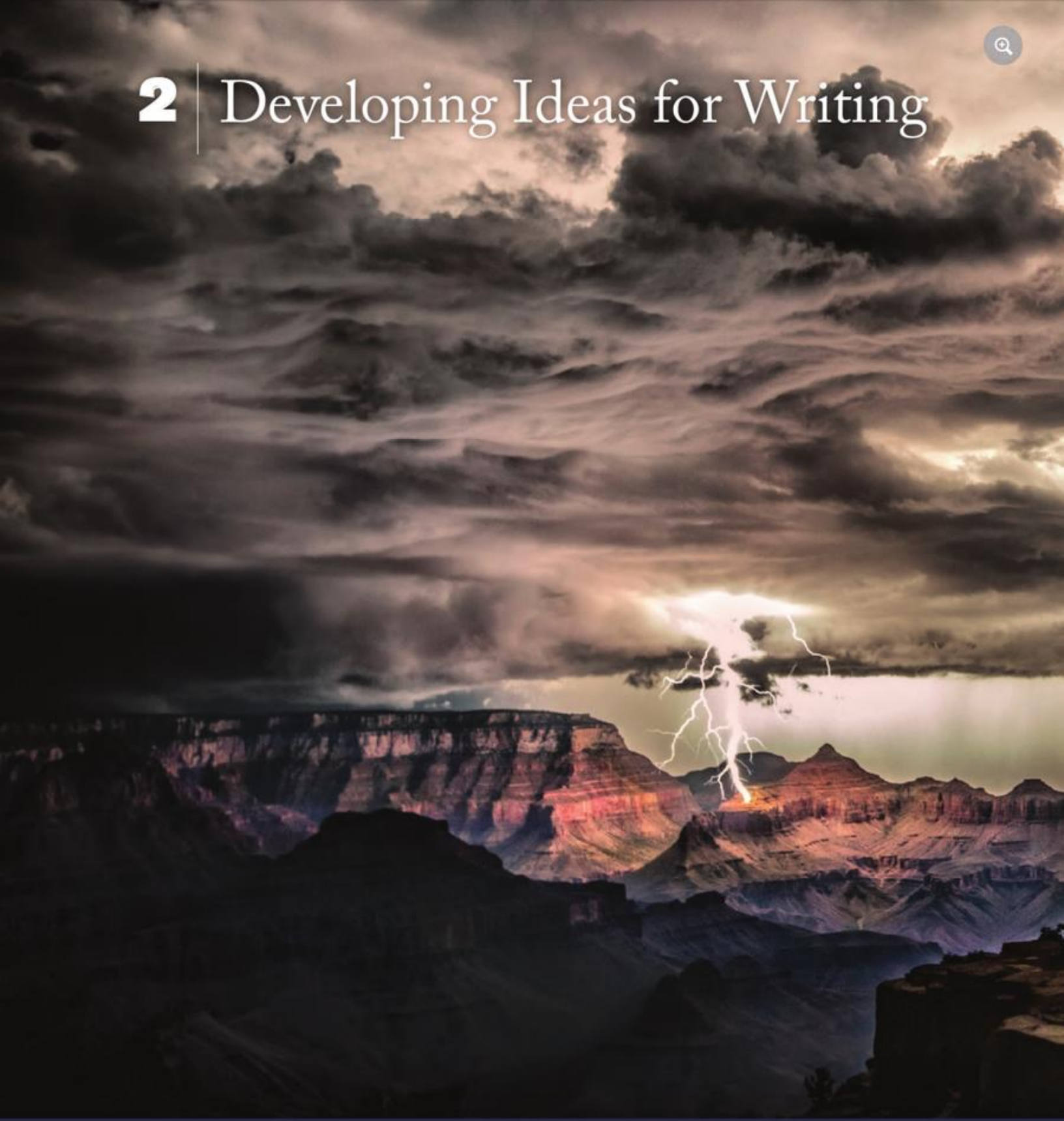
   _____

2. Jim Thorpe won medals.
   The medals were Olympic medals.
   They were gold medals.
   He won them in 1912.
   He was not allowed to keep the medals..

   _____

   _____

2 Developing Ideas for Writing



OBJECTIVES

- Brainstorm ideas for writing
- Identify and write simple and compound sentences
- Use descriptive adjectives
- Write effective titles
- Write a paragraph



A lightning storm at night over the Grand Canyon in Arizona, USA

FREEWRITE | Have you ever experienced a dangerous or frightenig storm? What did you do? How did you feel? Write five to ten sentences.

What Is Brainstorming?

How do writers find topics for their writing? One way is brainstorming.

Brainstorming is quickly writing down all the thoughts that come into your head. When you brainstorm, you do not think about whether an idea is good or bad or whether your writing is correct. You simply write your ideas as fast as you can. This is called brainstorming because it feels like there is a storm of ideas in your head.

For example, imagine there is a fire at your school right now. What should you do? Here are some ideas that someone might brainstorm. Do you have any other ideas you can add?



ACTIVITY 1 | Brainstorming practice

Read the situation. Then brainstorm ideas using the cluster diagram below. Your goal is to write as many ideas as you can in two minutes. Do not worry about being right or wrong.

Next Saturday is your grandmother's birthday. She is going to be 85 years old. What will you get for her? Make a list of five suitable birthday gifts for her on this special day.



Brainstorming Ideas with Others

Sometimes it is helpful to work with other writers and share ideas. Remember that in brainstorming, there are no bad ideas. The purpose of brainstorming is to produce as many ideas as possible. The advantage of group brainstorming is that you have more ideas and you also get some immediate feedback as people react to each new idea.

ACTIVITY 2 | Group brainstorming practice

Work in a group. Compare your ideas from Activity 1. Write your group's three best ideas.

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

ACTIVITY 3 | Writing about your ideas

Complete the sentences with information about your group's three best ideas.

1. Our group thinks the best gift is _____

   because _____.

2. Our second idea is _____

   because _____.

3. Our third suggestion is _____

   because _____.

ACTIVITY 4 | Presenting your group's ideas

With your group, follow these steps to prepare a presentation of your gift ideas.

1. Prepare five slides (or choose another way to present).

   Slide 1: Give the title of your slide show. Include the names of your group members.

   Slides 2, 3, and 4: Prepare one slide for each of your three ideas. What is the idea? You may want to add some short phrases to catch the audience's attention.

   Slide 5: Explain why your three ideas are perfect for this occasion.

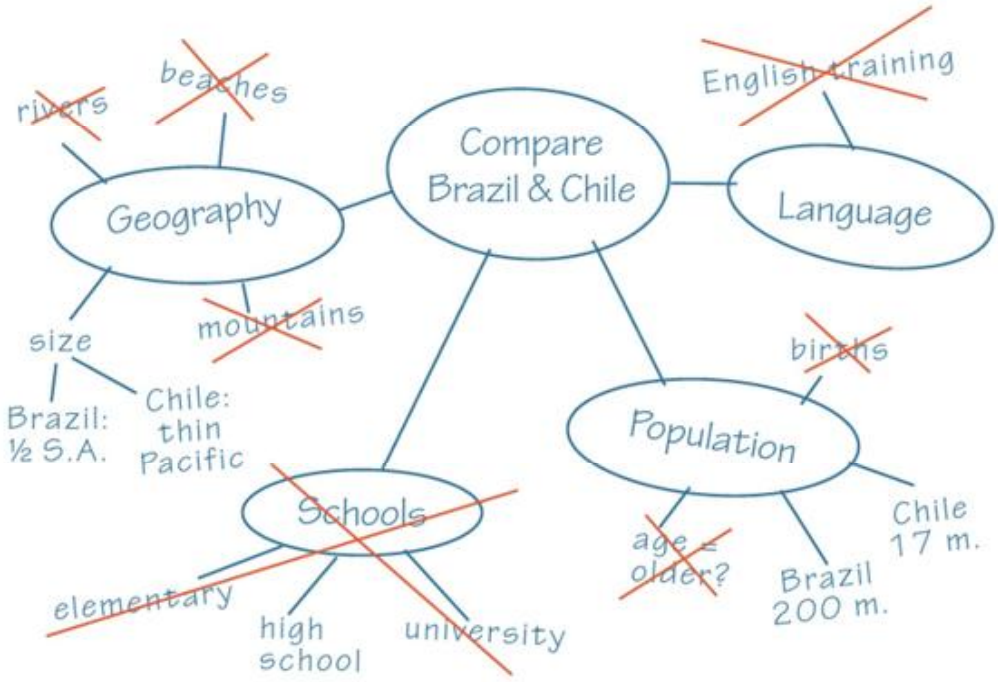
2. Present your group's ideas to the whole class. After all of the presentations, talk about the pros and cons of some of the ideas. As a class, choose the best one or two ideas.

How Brainstorming Works

A good writer brainstorms a topic by completing these two important steps:

1. thinking about the topic
2. quickly writing down words and ideas

Some writers use cluster diagrams to connect their ideas. Look at this example, which shows brainstorming for Paragraph 1.1, "Chile and Brazil." You can see that the writer wrote many ideas and crossed out some of them. There are several ideas that are not in the final paragraph. In addition, a few ideas in the final paragraph are not in the diagram.



ACTIVITY 5 | Brainstorming practice

Follow these steps to brainstorm a paragraph about dangerous weather situations.

1. Think of a few dangerous weather situations. What are three things a person should do in each kind of weather? Brainstorm ideas in your notebook. Use a cluster diagram.
2. Circle the ideas that you think are the best ones to include in a paragraph.
3. Compare and discuss your ideas with a partner. When you compare your notes, be prepared to say why you want to keep some ideas and why you want to take out others. Decide which weather situation is best to write about. What information will be in the final paragraph? Share your decisions with the class.

Grammar: Simple vs. Compound Sentences

Simple sentences usually have one subject and one verb. In other words, they have one independent clause. An **independent clause** has one subject-verb relationship, and it can stand alone as a sentence. Sometimes a simple sentence has more than one subject or verb, but it never has more than one clause.

SIMPLE SENTENCES	
SUBJECT(S)	VERB(S) + OTHER INFORMATION
Chile	**imports** oil from Brazil.
Chile	**imports** oil and **exports** copper.
Chile and **Brazil**	**import** clothing from China.
Chile and **Brazil**	**import** clothing and **export** copper.

Compound sentences are usually made of two simple sentences (independent clauses). Compound sentences need a coordinating conjunction (*and, but, or, so*) to connect the two sentences. Use a comma before the connecting word in a compound sentence.

COMPOUND SENTENCES		
INDEPENDENT CLAUSE 1	CONJ	INDEPENDENT CLAUSE 2
Chile exports copper,	**and**	**Brazil exports** sugar.
Chile has a very long seacoast,	**so**	**fishing is** a big business there.
Chile is an extremely long country,	**but**	**it is** not wide at all.
Tourists can visit the pyramids,	**or**	**they can relax** on a beach.

If both sentences have a noun that names the same person, place, or thing, replace the second noun with a pronoun. Do not repeat the noun.

Tourists can visit the pyramids, or **they** can relax on a beach.

ACTIVITY 12 | Identifying sentence types

For each sentence, underline the subject(s) and circle the verb(s). Then write *S* if it is a simple sentence or *C* if it is a compound sentence. Add a comma in the compound sentences.

_____ **1.** Confusing words such as the verbs *make* and *do* may cause problems for some students.

_____ **2.** This process feels like a storm of ideas in your mind so it is called "brainstorming."

_____ **3.** Certain words in a title may catch the reader's attention but some titles are too general and do not create interest.

_____ **4.** An independent clause has one subject-verb relationship and it can stand alone as a sentence.

_____ **5.** All of the sentences in a well-written paragraph talk about one topic.

_____ **6.** The Statue of Liberty weighs 450,000 pounds (204,117 kilograms) and it is 152 feet (46 meters) high.

_____ **7.** Unlike in previous years, the slow, brown water in the Galona River today does not contain fish or plants.

_____ **8.** Sometimes a simple sentence has a compound subject or verb but it never has more than one clause.

ACTIVITY 13 | Identifying sentence types

For each sentence in the paragraph, underline the subject(s) and circle the main verb(s). Add a comma in the compound sentences.

PARAGRAPH 2.4

A Visit to New York City

Each year, millions of excited tourists from the United States and other countries all over the world travel to New York City. About 80 percent of these visitors come from the United States and about 20 percent come from other countries. These tourists come to see the bright lights and exciting life of New York City. Two of the most popular destinations for tourists in New York are the Empire State Building and the Statue of Liberty. Perhaps one of the most interesting and most amazing things to see is Central Park. Many tourists start their New York City experience by visiting Times Square. Some tourists want to go on tours through companies but other tourists prefer to discover the city on their own. New York City has many things to see and do so millions of people visit the city each year.



ACTIVITY 14 | Analyzing compound sentences

For each sentence, underline the subject(s) and circle the main verb(s). Then add a comma.

WORDS TO KNOW Activity 14

area: (n) a general place
assistance: (n) help
contract: (n) a business agreement in writing
customer: (n) a person who buys things
fee: (n) a payment for services
final: (adj) the last
function: (v) to work
location: (n) a place
section: (n) a part
similar: (adj) like

1. The **location** of the city is near the ocean but the weather in this **area** can be very dry.
2. Last year's **contract** was not easy to understand and the new contract is **similar**.
3. The first **section** of the **final** exam asks questions about the War of 1812 and it will take about 20 minutes to answer well.
4. Some **customers** want a great deal of **assistance** when making a purchase but others prefer to **function** independently.
5. People do not understand how to pay late **fees** so the instructions are on the website.

ACTIVITY 15 | Writing compound sentences

Complete each compound sentence. Be sure to add a comma in the correct location.

1. Washington, DC, is the capital of the country but _____
2. Fast food is very cheap so _____
3. Learning new vocabulary is important and _____
4. Some students have a part-time job and _____
5. September has 30 days so _____

Titles

A **title** tells you what you will find in a book, a movie, a story, or a text. A title is not usually a sentence. A title is usually very short. Sometimes the title is only one word, such as the movie titles *Spiderman, Batman,* or *Titanic.*

A good title has something that catches the reader's interest, but it does not tell everything about the paragraph. For example, imagine that you wrote a paragraph about why it is difficult to write well in English. Consider these possible titles for this paragraph:

TITLE	COMMENT
English Is Difficult	✗ A title is not usually a sentence.
A Difficult Task	✗ The word *task* may interest the reader, but this title is still too general.
Difficulties in English	✗ The word *difficulties* catches the reader's attention. The word *English* tells us what kind of difficulties, but there is no mention of *writing.* This paragraph is about writing in English.
Challenges with Writing in English	✔ This title uses the word *challenges*, which attracts readers' attention. The title also mentions *writing* and *English*, so the reader knows exactly what to expect from the paragraph.

ACTIVITY 16 | Choosing a good title

Read the three titles and check (✓) the best one.

1. _____ Do Not Get a Cat for a Pet
_____ Problems with Having a Pet Cat
_____ I Will Never Have a Cat Again

2. _____ How to Buy a Used Car
_____ Buying a Used Car Can Be a Problem
_____ Cars

3. _____ Halloween Is Fun for Kids
_____ Halloween, Fun, and Kids
_____ The Best Holiday for Kids

4. _____ Popcorn Is Good for Our Health
_____ The Health Benefits of Popcorn
_____ Healthy Times for Popcorn

5. _____ Learning to Use U.S. Money
_____ A Dime Is Smaller Than a Penny
_____ Pennies, Nickels, Dimes, Quarters

6. _____ Three Good Websites for Cheap Travel
_____ I Prefer These Three Websites
_____ Best Website

7. _____ Meat Is Bad for Humans
_____ A Vegetarian Breakfast and Lunch
_____ Benefits of a Vegetarian Diet

8. _____ Two Fast-Food Meals
_____ Fast Food
_____ Cheeseburgers: Taste Better Than Fried Chicken



Looking up at the old Chicago Water Tower and modern skyscrapers

ACTIVITY 22 | Combining sentences

Combine the ideas into one sentence. You may change the word forms, but do not change or omit any ideas. There may be more than one answer.

1. Chicago is a city.
Chicago is modern.
Chicago has many buildings.
The buildings in Chicago are tall.
Chicago has beautiful architecture.

_____

_____

2. Writers should make a list.
This is a list of ideas.
The ideas are important.
The ideas are also interesting.
Writers should do this before they begin writing.
These writers are serious.

_____

_____

3. Wood is a resource.
This resource is natural.
This resource is abundant.
This resource is in Canada.

_____

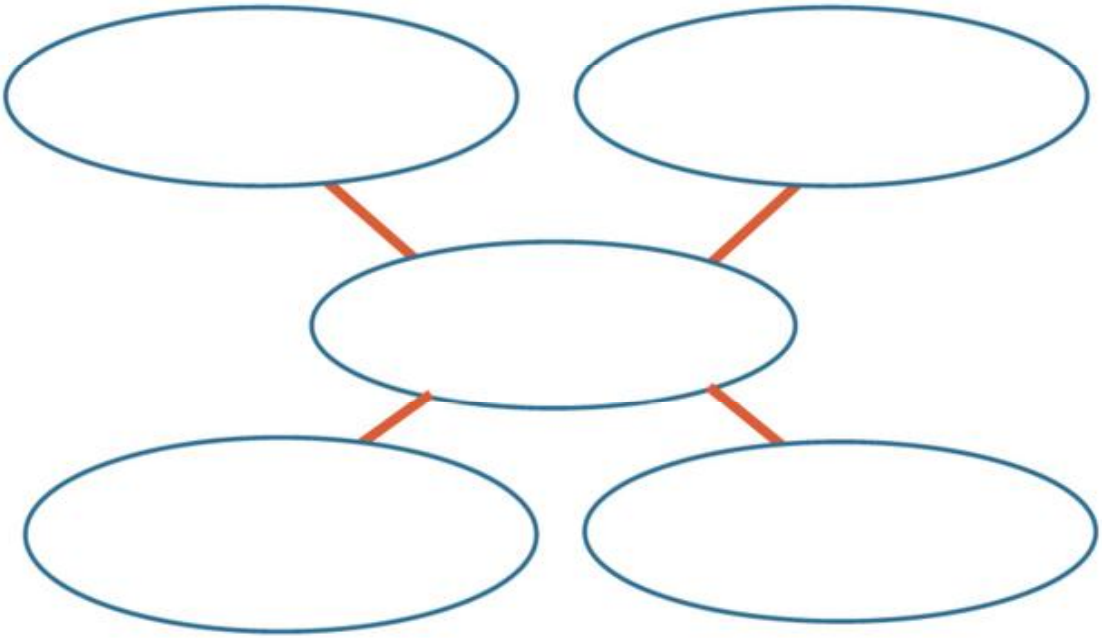
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WRITING

ACTIVITY 23 | Brainstorming and writing a paragraph

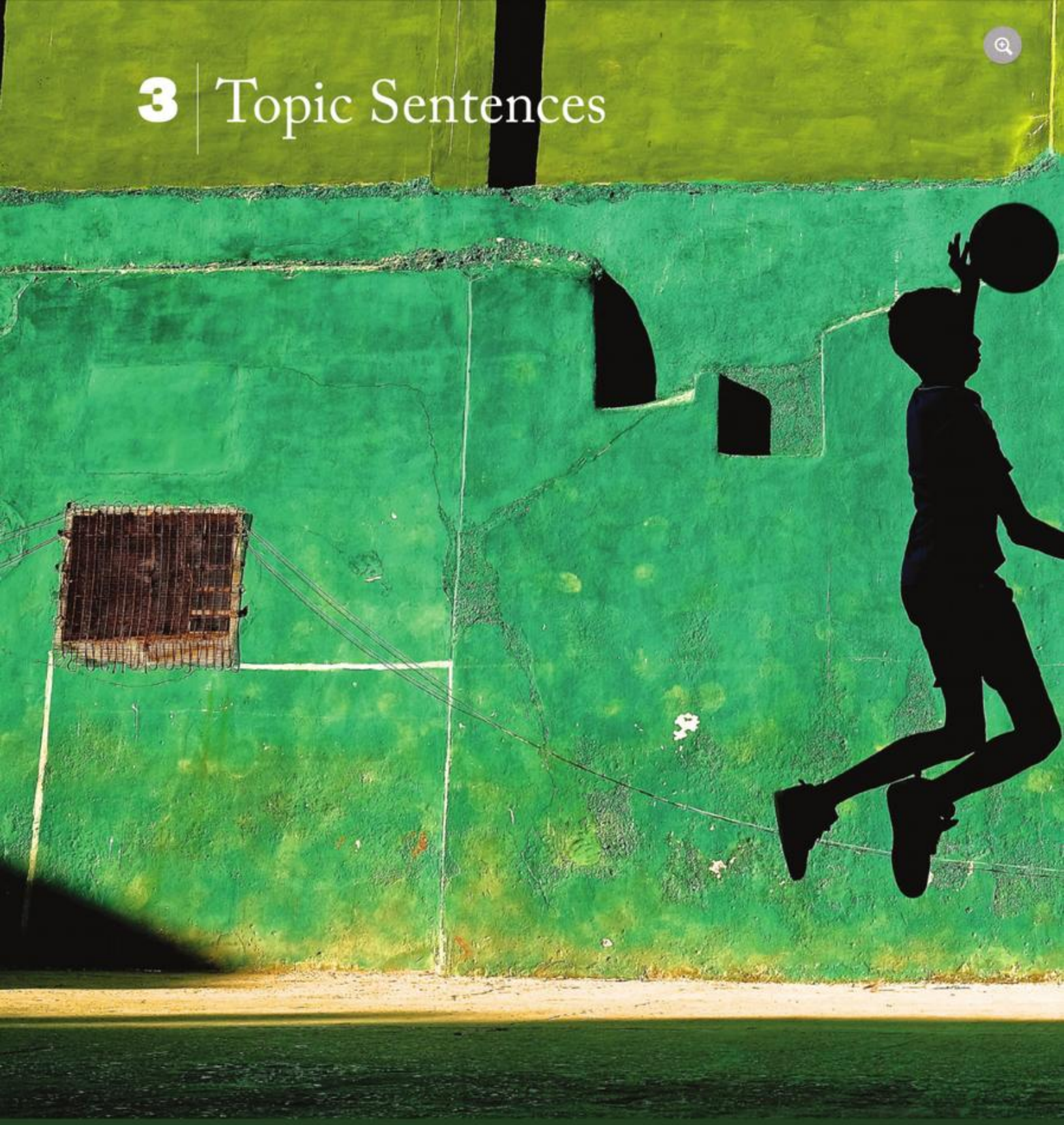
Write a paragraph. Follow these guidelines.

1. Choose one of these topics: sports, technology, or vacations. Use the cluster diagram to brainstorm a possible paragraph about the topic. Put the main topic in the center and ideas about it in the outer circles. You can add more supporting information around each circle.



2. Look at your ideas and cross out the ones that you do not think will work.
3. Use the ideas that you brainstormed to create sentences for your paragraph. Write a paragraph with five to ten sentences on a separate piece of paper. Include at least two compound sentences. Use commas correctly.
4. Include the four features of a good paragraph.
   - ☐ Is the first line of the paragraph indented?
   - ☐ Does the paragraph have a topic sentence that states the main idea?
   - ☐ Are all of the sentences in the paragraph about the topic?
   - ☐ Does the paragraph have a concluding sentence?
5. Give your paragraph a title.
6. Use at least two of the vocabulary words or phrases presented in the Words to Know box.
7. Be sure to proofread. Check for subject-verb agreement and use a variety of descriptive adjectives.

3 Topic Sentences



OBJECTIVES

- Analyze a paragraph
- Study and write effective topic sentences
- Use commas correctly in sentences
- Identify and write complex sentences
- Write a paragraph



Young boys play basketball after school in Havana, Cuba.

FREEWRITE | Look at the photo and write a story about one or all of the boys. Use your imagination. Begin *Every day after school,...* Write five to ten sentences.

ELEMENTS OF GREAT WRITING

What Is a Topic Sentence?

A **topic sentence** states the main idea of a paragraph. It is usually found at the beginning of a paragraph. A topic sentence has several important jobs. It:

- introduces the main idea
- limits or focuses the topic
- often tells the reader how the information will be organized in the paragraph

ACTIVITY 1 | Analyzing a paragraph

Discuss the questions. Then read the paragraph and answer the questions that follow.

1. Can you name three benefits of exercising regularly?
2. What are three reasons that people do not exercise regularly?

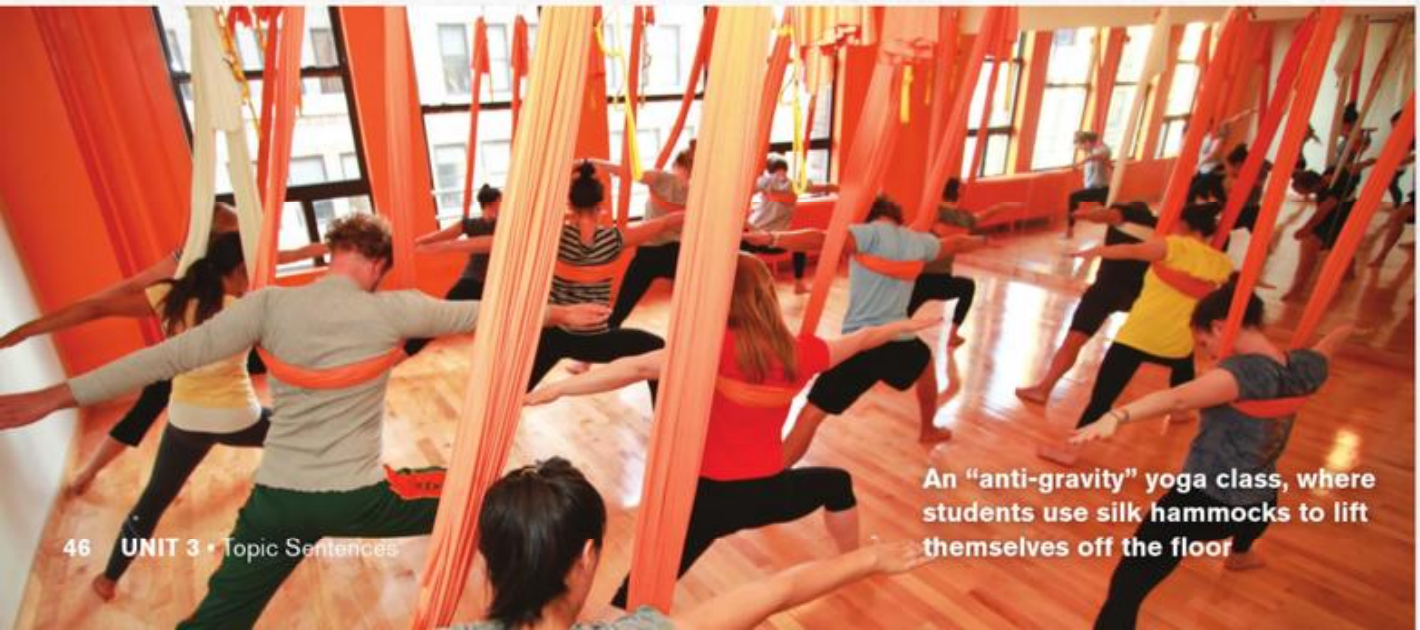
WORDS TO KNOW Paragraph 3.1

climb: (v) to go up
improve: (v) to make better
in good shape: (idiom) having good physical condition
reduce: (v) to make less

PARAGRAPH 3.1

Reasons for Exercise

There are many excellent reasons for exercising several times each week. First, people who exercise look better. Exercise is important to keep our bodies **in good shape.** In addition, people who exercise have more energy. For example, a person who exercises can walk up stairs or **climb** hills more easily. People who exercise have a healthier heart, too. Finally, exercise **reduces** stress and helps you have a clear mind. Too much stress can cause you to worry a lot, and that is not good for your health. For these reasons, if you want to **improve** your health, you should exercise regularly.



An "anti-gravity" yoga class, where students use silk hammocks to lift themselves off the floor

1. What is the topic sentence? Write it here.

_____

_____

2. What do you expect to read about based on the topic sentence?

_____

_____

3. These words or expressions are very important to the organization of the paragraph. Number them in the same order that they are in the paragraph.

_____ finally _____ first _____ in addition _____ for these reasons

4. Read the last sentence carefully. What do you think the purpose of this sentence is? Begin your answer with *The purpose of this sentence is to . . .*

_____

_____

ACTIVITY 2 | Recognizing good topic sentences

Read each set of sentences. Write the general topic that the sentences share. Then check (✓) the sentence you think is the best topic sentence. Discuss your reasons with the class.

1. General topic: winter	_____ Winter is a good season. _____ Winter weather is cold, and it snows. ✓ The best season for children is winter.
2. General topic:	_____ Soccer is popular for many reasons. _____ For a soccer game, players need a special leather ball. _____ Soccer is a nice game.
3. General topic:	_____ There are many people in Los Angeles. _____ People from many different cultures live in Los Angeles. _____ Los Angeles is a big city in California.
4. General topic:	_____ Monolingual dictionaries have only one language, but bilingual dictionaries have two languages. _____ Many language students prefer bilingual dictionaries to monolingual dictionaries. _____ Dictionaries that have two languages, such as French and English, are called bilingual dictionaries.

Features of a Topic Sentence

A topic sentence has these important features.

1. **It has a controlling idea** that limits the topic and guides the flow of the paragraph. The controlling idea tells the reader what you will say about your topic. Here are two topic sentences. The topic is circled and the controlling idea is underlined.

   - (Soccer) is popular for many reasons.
     Explanation: The reader expects the paragraph to explain why soccer is popular.
   - Many (language students) prefer bilingual dictionaries to monolingual dictionaries.
     Explanation: The reader expects the paragraph to explain why this statement is true.

2. **It is not a fact.** For example, "Libraries have books" is not a good topic sentence. The information in this sentence is true, but it is a fact and there is little to say about it.

3. **It is specific.** "Tea is delicious" is not a good topic sentence because the information in the sentence is too general. If you want to write a paragraph about tea, make your topic sentence more specific, such as "Green tea has many health benefits."

4. **It is not *too* specific.** "This dictionary contains more than 42,000 words" limits the topic too much. There is nothing else for the writer to say, so the paragraph cannot continue.

ACTIVITY 3 | Recognizing controlling ideas in topic sentences

Read each topic sentence. The topic is circled. Underline the controlling idea. What information do you expect to find in the paragraph? Share your answers with a partner.

WORDS TO KNOW Activity 3

addictive: (adj) having qualities that make you want to do something again and again
advantage: (n) a good or desirable quality or feature
confuse: (v) to mix up mentally so one cannot understand
educational: (adj) describes something that teaches or involves learning
investigator: (n) a person who tries to learn how something happened

1. (The new test) has three sections dealing with three important skills.

   Expectation: _____

   _____

2. The shocking (crash of the airplane) off the coast of Florida **confused investigators.**

   Expectation: _____

   _____

3. Crossword puzzles are not only **educational** and fun, but also **addictive.**

Expectation: _____

_____

4. Recent research has shown once again that eating dark green, leafy vegetables such as broccoli and cabbage may reduce the risk of some types of cancer.

Expectation: _____

_____

5. Although buying a house may seem like a good idea, renting an apartment has many **advantages.**

Expectation: _____

_____

ACTIVITY 4 | Recognizing good topic sentences and controlling ideas

Read the three sentences. Check (✓) the best topic sentence. Underline the controlling idea in that sentence. Be prepared to explain your selections.

WORDS TO KNOW Activity 4

contribution: (n) what someone does to help make something successful

immigrant: (n) someone who comes to live in a different country

recognize: (v) to give attention or notice to

1. _____ In an English class, most of the female students receive higher grades than the males.
   _____ Research has shown female students like learning languages more than males do.
   _____ Many students like languages very much.

2. _____ Cats are better pets than goldfish for many reasons.
   _____ Cats and goldfish are both animals.
   _____ Cats cannot swim very well, but goldfish can.

3. _____ The people in my office eat lunch from 11:30 to 12:30.
   _____ Yesterday I went to work late, and my boss was of course very angry.
   _____ Yesterday was the worst day of my life.

4. _____ Paul Cézanne was born in France in the last century.

   _____ Paul Cézanne, the father of modern art, made important **contributions** to the history of art.

   _____ Many of the museum visitors **recognized** Paul Cézanne's work immediately.

5. _____ Many Canadians speak French, and some of them speak Chinese.

   _____ The current population of Canada includes **immigrants** from all over the world.

   _____ A large number of new immigrants live in British Columbia, Canada, but not many of them speak German.

ACTIVITY 5 | Adding controlling ideas

These topic sentences are too general. Using the same topic, write a topic sentence with a clear controlling idea. Then compare your sentences with a partner's.

1. Flowers are beautiful.

   Flowers are the best gift to receive when you are feeling down.

   OR Only four kinds of flowers grow during the short summers in Alaska.

2. Cats are nice. _____

3. Paris is the capital of France. _____

4. Reading blogs is interesting. _____

5. Running is a hobby. _____

ACTIVITY 6 | Studying the controlling idea of a paragraph

Answer the questions.

1. Write the topic sentence from Paragraph 3.1 here.

2. Underline the controlling idea(s) in that topic sentence.

3. How is the controlling idea connected to the information in the paragraph?

ACTIVITY 7 | Writing topic sentences in paragraphs

Read the paragraphs and write a topic sentence for each. Be sure to indent the first line.

WORDS TO KNOW Paragraphs 3.2 to 3.4

connection: (n) an association
control: (v) to manage
culture: (n) the beliefs and actions of a group
depend (on): (v) to need
effective: (adj) useful
imagine: (v) to make a picture in your head
in sum: (connector) in conclusion

PARAGRAPH 3.2

Reasons for Playing Instruments

_____

_____

Some people learn to play a musical instrument because they want to have fun. They want to play it with their friends or maybe in a band. Other people learn to play an instrument because it is part of their **culture**. Certain instruments are popular in some cultures, such as the guitar in Spain or the oud[1] in the Middle East. Sometimes, people even learn to play an instrument because they think it will make them smarter. They want to keep their mind busy, and music is different from the work they think about all day long. **In sum,** there is clearly not just one main reason that people play a musical instrument.

[1]oud: a stringed instrument that is popular in the Middle East

PARAGRAPH 3.3

Differences between Modern Reptiles and Dinosaurs

_____

_____

One is size. Most modern reptiles are small. Dinosaurs were much larger than any reptile on Earth now. Second, the legs of most reptiles today are on the sides of their body. However, dinosaurs' legs were on the bottom of their body. In this way, dinosaurs could stand up on their back legs. Third, today's reptiles use the environment to **control** their body temperature. In contrast, dinosaurs controlled their own body temperature. They did not **depend on** what was around them. While reptiles and dinosaurs may seem very similar, they are actually very different.



A saltwater crocodile, the world's largest reptile


A hatchet

PARAGRAPH 3.4

A Method for Learning New Words

In the Keyword Method, language learners make a **connection** between the sound of the word they are trying to learn and a word in their first language. For example, a Japanese learner of English might connect the English word *hatchet* with the Japanese word *hachi*, which means "eight," because the two words have a similar sound. In the second step, learners make a picture in their heads to help them remember the word. In this case, the learner might **imagine** a person using a hatchet to cut down eight trees. For many language learners, the Keyword Method is **effective**.

Grammar: Complex Sentences

Three kinds of sentences are important for your writing: *simple*, *compound*, and *complex*.

- a **simple sentence** has one independent clause. An **independent clause** has one subject-verb relationship, and it can stand alone as a sentence.

  People from many different cultures **live** in Los Angeles.

- a **compound sentence** has two independent clauses that can stand alone. The two clauses are connected with words such as *and*, *but*, *so*.

  The weather there **is** hot, and **it** often **rains.**

- a **complex sentence** has one independent clause and one dependent clause Each clause has a subject-verb relationship. A **dependent clause** cannot stand alone. Here are two common types of dependent clauses.

TYPE OF DEPENDENT CLAUSE	EXAMPLES OF COMPLEX SENTENCES
An **adjective clause** gives more information about a noun it follows. It begins with a relative pronoun (*who/whom*, *that*, or *which*).	People **who exercise regularly** are healthier. Dictionaries **that have two languages** are useful.
An **adverb clause** begins with a connecting word, such as *because* (reason); *before*, *after*, *when* (time); *if* (condition); *although* (contrast).	They play the guitar **because they enjoy it.** **Before they start working,** they check email.

ACTIVITY 8 | Identifying types of sentences

Identify each sentence. Write *simple*, *compound*, or *complex*. Be ready to explain your answers.

1. _____ When I walked into the room, I was very nervous.
2. _____ Beijing has many famous tourist attractions, such as the Imperial Palace, Tian'anmen Square, and the Lama Temple.
3. _____ Central Park has a zoo and many other interesting places to visit, but sometimes it is too cold to visit in the winter.
4. _____ A good writer learns to create longer, more detailed sentences from simple ideas.
5. _____ Some families do not have the extra time that pets require.
6. _____ Although Bolívar's name is not as well-known outside Latin America, many people there consider him the most important historical person.
7. _____ Brazil and Chile are near each other, but these two South American countries are very different in geography, population, and language.
8. _____ Like most countries in South America, the majority of people in Chile speak Spanish.
9. _____ Before e-readers were invented, students had to carry several heavy books with them each day.
10. _____ E-readers are wireless, so students can carry them anywhere.

ACTIVITY 9 | Identifying types of complex sentences

Underline the dependent clause in each sentence. Write *Adj* if it is an adjective clause or *Adv* if it is an adverb clause.

1. _____ People who live in glass houses should not throw stones.
2. _____ If your photocopies cost 21 cents, your change should be four cents.
3. _____ Gumbo is a thick soup that is made with shrimp and vegetables.
4. _____ Bush became president after Clinton was president for eight years.
5. _____ The season that many young children enjoy a lot is summer.
6. _____ Because they do not go to school in summer, children often like summer more than other seasons.
7. _____ Most people become angry when their computer freezes.
8. _____ In class, we discussed problems that were common in the 1990s.

Mechanics: Commas

Commas are very important in writing because they help the reader understand the writer's message more easily.

EXPLANATION	EXAMPLES
Lists: A comma shows that a list has three or more things. We do not use a comma with two things. We use *and* instead of a comma.	I speak English, Spanish, and Japanese. I speak English and Spanish.
Compound sentences: A comma separates two independent clauses when there is a coordinating conjunction, such as *and, but, so, or.*	I speak three languages, **but** Adam speaks five.
Introductory words or phrases: A comma separates the subject from: • prepositional phrases (*In the winter of 1995, . . .*) • sequence words (*first, next, finally*) • transition words or phrases (*However, Therefore, In addition*)	**Last summer**, the beach lost a lot of sand. **First**, you will need to get a pencil. **Therefore**, we will not complete the project.
Adverb clauses: When the adverb clause is at the beginning of a sentence, use a comma after it. Do not use a comma if the adverb clause is at the end of a sentence.	**Because I speak three languages**, I can communicate with many people. I can communicate with many people **because I speak three languages**.

Note: For more information on commas, see Capitalization and Punctuation" in the *Writers Handbook.*

ACTIVITY 10 | Comma practice in sentences

Insert commas where necessary. Write the number of the comma rule/(s) (1, 2, 3, 4) on the line. Sometimes more than one rule is possible.

1. 2 Brazil is surrounded by Spanish-speaking countries, but most people in Brazil speak Portuguese.
2. _____ The flags of Chile France and Norway have blue white and red sections.
3. _____ Fortunately no one was hurt in the accident that happened yesterday.
4. _____ Italian French Spanish and Portuguese came from Latin.
5. _____ My friend has an e-reader and she convinced me to buy one.
6. _____ In the summer of 1940 German soldiers entered France.
7. _____ Because English came from German there are many similar words in the two languages.
8. _____ If you want to make cookies you need flour sugar oil and vanilla.

ACTIVITY 11 | Comma practice in a paragraph

Insert six commas in the paragraph where necessary. Be prepared to explain your choices. Some sentences are correct with no commas.

WORDS TO KNOW Paragraph 3.5

economy: (n) the production of a place

therefore: (connector) as a result

PARAGRAPH 3.5

Malaysia and Thailand

Because Malaysia and Thailand are next to each other we might think that these two countries share many similarities. In some ways, this is true. For example both countries are warm all year long. Both have many miles of beautiful beaches that attract tourists. In addition the **economy** of both countries is growing. However there are also several clear differences. For one, Malaysians and Thais speak completely different languages. The population of Malaysia is about 31 million while the population of Thailand is about 69 million. Thailand has a king, but Malaysia does not. Finally, Malaysia was part of Britain at one time but Thailand was never British. **Therefore** the fact that two countries are near each other does not always mean that they are similar.



Food vendor selling home-cooked local dishes at a street market stall, Sabah, Malaysia

ACTIVITY 15 | Vocabulary in writing

Choose five words from Words to Know. Write a complete sentence with each word. Use *because*, *if*, *before*, *after*, *when*, *while*, or *although* in two of your sentences. Remember to use commas correctly.

1. _____

_____

2. _____

_____

3. _____

_____

4. _____

_____

5. _____

_____

BUILDING BETTER SENTENCES

ACTIVITY 16 | Editing

Each sentence has (x) number of errors. Find and correct them.

1. Although some politicians in this country believes that the new law will make a difference in electricity costs most people think there will be no change. (2)
2. In the sum, gasoline prices will continue to rise each year, because companies want make more money on gasoline sales. (3)
3. Although some teachers retire when they are 55 year old the normal retirement age for a teacher in U.K. is 60. (3)
4. Brazil ranks fifth in population and it is the fifth most big country in the world. (2)
5. According to the article people thought their dinner tasted better, when they did not use social media. (2)
6. When a airplane take off the pilot and other crew are very busy. (3)

ACTIVITY 17 | Writing sentences

Write an original sentence using the words listed. You may change the form of the nouns (singular/plural) and verbs (tenses).

1. (politician / years) One of the local politicians has been in office for 18 years.

2. (a new car / because) _____

3. (if / cancel) _____

4. (famous / France) _____

5. (average / price) _____

6. (one / most difficult) _____

ACTIVITY 18 | Combining sentences

Combine the ideas into one sentence. You may change the word forms, but do not change or omit any ideas. There may be more than one answer.

1. A condition requires attention.
   The condition is a medical condition.
   The condition is serious.
   The attention is immediate.

2. Canada is a country.
   Canada is large.
   The population of Canada is very small.

3. The assignment is to write a paper.
The assignment is the last one.
The assignment is for our history class.
The class is British History.
The paper should explain how the War of 1812 started.

_____

_____

WRITING

ACTIVITY 19 | Brainstorming ideas for a paragraph

Choose one of these topics. Brainstorm ideas about it and write your ideas in a list or on a diagram. When you have finished, circle the ideas that you think are best to include in a paragraph.

- animal communication
- international flights
- learning a language
- smartphones

ACTIVITY 20 | Writing a paragraph

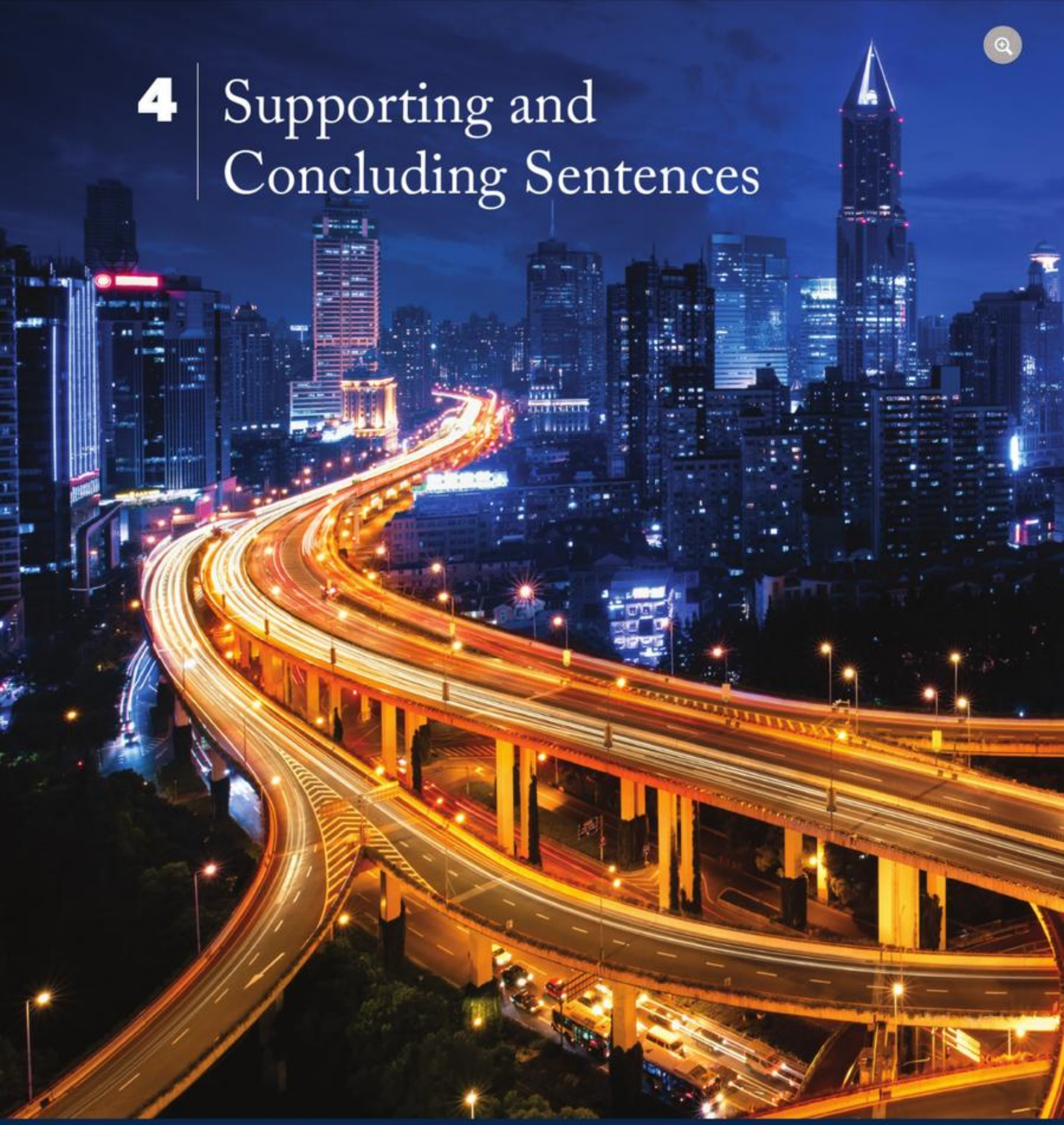
Use your brainstorming notes from Activity 19 to write a paragraph. Follow these guidelines.

1. Begin your paragraph with a topic sentence that has a clear controlling idea.
2. Use at least two of the vocabulary words or phrases presented in Words to Know.
3. Make sure that your paragraph has the four features as outlined in Unit 1.



Elephants touching, to greet each other, Addo Elephant National Park, South Africa

4 Supporting and Concluding Sentences



OBJECTIVES

- Study and write effective supporting and concluding sentences
- Avoid unrelated information
- Avoid sentence fragments, run-ons, and comma splices
- Use pronouns correctly for key nouns
- Write a paragraph



Elevated highways at night, Shanghai China

FREEWRITE

Look at the photo and write any ideas you have about the city, the roads and where they lead, and the feeling of driving on them at night. Write five to ten sentences.

What Are Supporting Sentences?

Supporting sentences give information that explains and expands on the topic sentence. They provide the details of the paragraph. They answer questions such as *Who? What? Where? When? Why?* and *How?* Good writers think about answers to questions like these when they write.

Remember that the controlling idea in the topic sentence guides the content of your supporting sentences.

ACTIVITY 1 | Predicting supporting content

Read each topic sentence. Circle the topic. Underline the controlling idea. Then predict the kind of supporting information you will find in the paragraph.

1. Although New York and Boston attract millions of tourists, one of the best cities to visit in the eastern United States is Washington, D.C.

   What kind of supporting information do you expect in this paragraph?

   _____

   _____

   _____

2. The Grand Palace is one of the most popular tourist destinations in Thailand.

   What kind of supporting information do you expect in this paragraph?

   _____

   _____

   _____

3. One of the people I admire the most is my great-grandmother Carla.

   What kind of supporting information do you expect in this paragraph?

   _____

   _____

   _____

ACTIVITY 2 | Checking your predictions

Read the three paragraphs. The supporting sentences are highlighted in blue. Look at your predictions in Activity 1. How well did you predict the supporting information? Discuss your predictions and results with a partner.

WORDS TO KNOW Paragraphs 4.1 to 4.3

amazed: (adj) surprised
complain: (v) to express unhappiness with a thing or person or situation
construction: (n) the act of building
destination: (n) a place someone travels to
opportunity: (n) a chance to do something
style: (n) a way of doing something
surround: (v) to be on all sides
survive: (v) to continue to live or exist after a difficult or dangerous situation

PARAGRAPH 4.1

A Great Tourist Destination

Although New York and Boston attract millions of tourists, one of the best cities to visit in the eastern United States is Washington, D.C. First, Washington has some of the most interesting landmarks[1] in the country. There are several beautiful memorials[2] to early U.S. presidents, including the Lincoln Memorial, the Jefferson Memorial, and the Washington Monument. There is also a tour of the White House, which is the home of the president of the United States. Second, Washington has wonderful museums that are free to visit. The Smithsonian Institution is a large group of museums that offers excellent **opportunities** to learn about everything from natural history to aerospace. Finally, Georgetown is a historic area in the northwest part of Washington that has shopping, restaurants, and entertainment for the whole family. Washington, D.C., does not have the large number of visitors that New York or Boston has, but this important city is one of the best **destinations** for tourists.

[1]landmark: a historic building; a well-known location
[2]memorial: a statue or some other structure that helps people remember something or someone



The Jefferson Memorial, Washington, D.C.



PARAGRAPH 4.2

The Grand Palace in Bangkok

The Grand Palace is one of the most popular tourist destinations in Thailand. The **construction** of the palace began in 1782, and the kings and royal families lived there until 1925. The palace area is more than 2 million square feet (185,806 square meters), and the wall that **surrounds** the palace is more than 6,000 feet (1829 meters) long. This large area includes several buildings, gardens, and special rooms with a mix of Asian and European **styles**. It is a beautiful place with a lot of history, so it is easy to understand why so many tourists visit the Grand Palace each year.

PARAGRAPH 4.3

An Immigrant in the Family

One of the people I admire the most is my great-grandmother Carla. She came to the United States from Italy in 1911 as a young woman. Like many other immigrants at that time, she had nothing when she arrived. Soon after her arrival **in** New York, she began working as a seamstress[1] in Brooklyn. Not long after that, she met and married my great-grandfather. They immediately began their large family. Great-grandma Carla had eight children—five boys and three girls. In addition to taking care of such a large family in a new country, my great-grandmother **survived** discrimination[2] as a foreigner, two World Wars, the Great Depression[3], and a long list of illnesses. However, she almost never **complained**, and she was very happy with her new life in America. If you learn more about my great-grandmother Carla, you, too, will be **amazed** at her life.

[1]seamstress: a woman who makes clothing
[2]discrimination: unfair treatment
[3]the Great Depression: a period of difficult economic times in the U.S. between 1929 and 1939

What do Supporting Sentences Do?

Supporting sentences have different goals. Writers use them to do one or more of the following:

- **Explain:** When she was 10 years old, her family left their farm for economic reasons.
- **Describe:** They lived in a beautiful three-story castle in the middle of the forest.
- **Give reasons:** Some people quit their jobs because of the difficult working conditions.
- **Give facts:** More than 10 percent of this university's student population is international.
- **Give examples:** For example, California is the top producer of peaches, grapes, and strawberries.
- **Define:** Gumbo is a thick soup made of seafood and meat served over rice.

ACTIVITY 3 | Identifying supporting sentences

Look back at Paragraphs 4.1–4.3. What are the goals of the supporting sentences? Compare your answers with a partner. More than one goal is possible. Be prepared to explain your answers.

1. What are the goals of the supporting sentences in Paragraph 4.1? _____

_____

2. What are the goals of the supporting sentences in Paragraph 4.2? _____

_____

3. What are the goals of the supporting sentences in Paragraph 4.3? _____

_____

ACTIVITY 4 | Writing topic sentences

For each topic, brainstorm some ideas on a separate piece of paper. Then write a topic sentence with a controlling idea. Circle the controlling ideas.

1. vacation: Orlando, Florida, is the best vacation destination for children

2. mathematics: _____

_____

3. a family member _____

_____

4. an animal or pet _____

_____

5. a best friend: _____

_____

6. a restaurant: _____

_____

ACTIVITY 5 | Asking for more information

Choose three of your topic sentences from Activity 4 and write them below. Then write three questions about each topic. Use *wh-* questions.

1. Topic Sentence: Orlando, Florida, is the best vacation destination for children.
   a. Why do children like Orlando?
   b. _____
   c. _____

2. Topic Sentence: _____

   _____
   a. _____
   b. _____
   c. _____

3. Topic Sentence: _____

   _____
   a. _____
   b. _____
   c. _____

WRITER'S NOTE Staying on Track

As you write a paragraph. you should always look back at your topic sentence. Do not include any information that is unrelated to the topic sentence. It is very easy to lose track of the main idea if you do not refer to the topic sentence from time to time. By asking questions about your topic sentence after you are finished writing, you can better identify the content that should stay in your paragraph and the content that you should remove from your paragraph.

Grammar: Avoiding Fragments

EXPLANATION	EXAMPLES
A **sentence fragment** is not a complete sentence. Often it is: • without a subject, a verb, or both • a dependent clause, which is never a complete sentence To correct a sentence fragment: • add a subject or verb • combine two clauses with a connector	✗ I went to Italy last summer. Was a wonderful trip. ✗ Students do not often major in art. Because they worry about job opportunities. ✓ I went to Italy last summer. **It** was a wonderful trip. ✓ Students do not often major in art **because** they worry about job opportunities.

ACTIVITY 9 | Correcting sentence fragments

Work with a partner. Discuss what the problem is in each sentence. Then write a correct sentence. More than one correction may be possible.

1. One of the most common reasons that people decide to become a vegetarian.

   One of the most common reasons that people decide to become a vegetarian is to improve their health.

2. Because the wind and rain were so strong when the airplane tried to take off.

3. Although the price of gasoline is extremely high at the current time.

4. In order to fly to an international destination.

5. For some teachers, a fragment a very serious type of mistake because shows a lack of understanding of the structure of a sentence.

Grammar: Avoiding Run-Ons and Comma Splices

EXPLANATION	EXAMPLES
A **run-on sentence** combines two independent clauses (complete sentences) without punctuation or a conjunction. To correct a run-on sentence: • separate the sentences into two with a period • add a connector	✗ I went to Italy I did not visit Milan. ✓ I went to Italy. I did not visit Milan. ✓ I went to Italy, **but** I did not visit Milan. ✓ **Though** I went to Italy, I did not visit Milan.
A **comma splice** occurs when two independent clauses are separated by a comma. To correct a comma splice: • add a connecting word after the comma • create two sentences from the one	✗ I went to Italy last summer, it was a great trip. ✓ I went to Italy last summer, **and** it was a great trip. ✓ I went to Italy last summer. **It** was a great trip.

ACTIVITY 10 | Correcting run-on sentences and comma splices

Discuss the type of error in each sentence with a partner. Write *RO* for run-on sentence or *CS* for comma splice. Then write a correct sentence. More than one correction may be possible.

1. CS A whale is one of the largest animals on Earth, few people have seen one.

A whale is one of the largest animals on Earth. Few people have seen one.

OR Although the whale is one of the largest animals on Earth, few people have seen one.

2. _____ Language-learning software helps students learn languages, many students buy this software in addition to their class books.

3. _____ It is a difficult time for many people, however, people are strong and they will survive.

4. _____ *Dancing with the Stars* is a well-known television show the dancing is very exciting.

5. _____ This magazine has great articles on international events it won awards last year.

What Is a Concluding Sentence?

The **concluding sentence** is the last sentence of a paragraph. It concludes, or ends, a paragraph. It tells the reader that you have finished talking about the idea introduced by the topic sentence.

A concluding sentence often has one or more of these four purposes:

- **It restates the main idea.** It summarizes the main idea or points in the paragraph. Often it says about the same thing as the topic sentence, but in different words.
- **It offers a suggestion.** It tells readers something they should think or do.
- **It gives an opinion.** It tells readers the writer's thoughts or beliefs about the topic.
- **It makes a prediction.** It tells readers what might happen in the future.

The following are transitional words and phrases commonly used at the beginning of a concluding sentence. There is usually a comma after the transitional word or phrase.

As a result,	Clearly,	Therefore,	Surely,
Certainly,	Overall,	Thus,	For these reasons,
In conclusion,	Because of this,	For this reason,	In brief,

ACTIVITY 11 | Analyzing concluding sentences

Look back and read the topic sentence and the concluding sentence from each paragraph listed below. Write the concluding sentence. Then discuss with a partner which purpose listed above best fits each concluding sentence.

1. Paragraph 4.1 "A Great Tourist Destination"

Concluding Sentence: _____

_____

2. Paragraph 4.3 "An Immigrant in the Family"

Concluding Sentence: _____

_____

3. Paragraph 4.4 "My Dining Experience at Fresh Market"

Concluding Sentence: _____

_____

4. Paragraph 4.6 "Traveling between Rome and Paris"

Concluding Sentence: _____

_____

ACTIVITY 12 | Analyzing paragraphs

Read the paragraphs and complete these tasks for each one.

1. Underline the topic sentence.
2. Cross out the sentence that is not an appropriate supporting sentence.
3. Write a concluding sentence on the lines provided.

WORDS TO KNOW Paragraphs 4.8 to 4.10

amount: (n) how much (of something)
assign: (v) to give tasks to do
due to: (prep) because of
replace: (v) to change one thing for another
shallow: (adj) not deep

PARAGRAPH 4.8

Adjusting to College Life

When I started college, I was surprised at the **amount** of studying that was necessary. I had to change my study habits. In high school, I rarely studied, yet my grades were good. In college, all my professors thought their class was the most important. My favorite class in college was British History. Each professor **assigned** a tremendous amount of homework. As a result, my free time became very limited. Reading assignments, group projects, and research **replaced** my time with friends. My classes kept me so busy that I only saw my friends on Saturday nights. This schedule was a big change from high school, where I used to play sports, have fun, and see my friends several times a week. _____

_____

PARAGRAPH 4.9

Four Ways to Cook an Egg

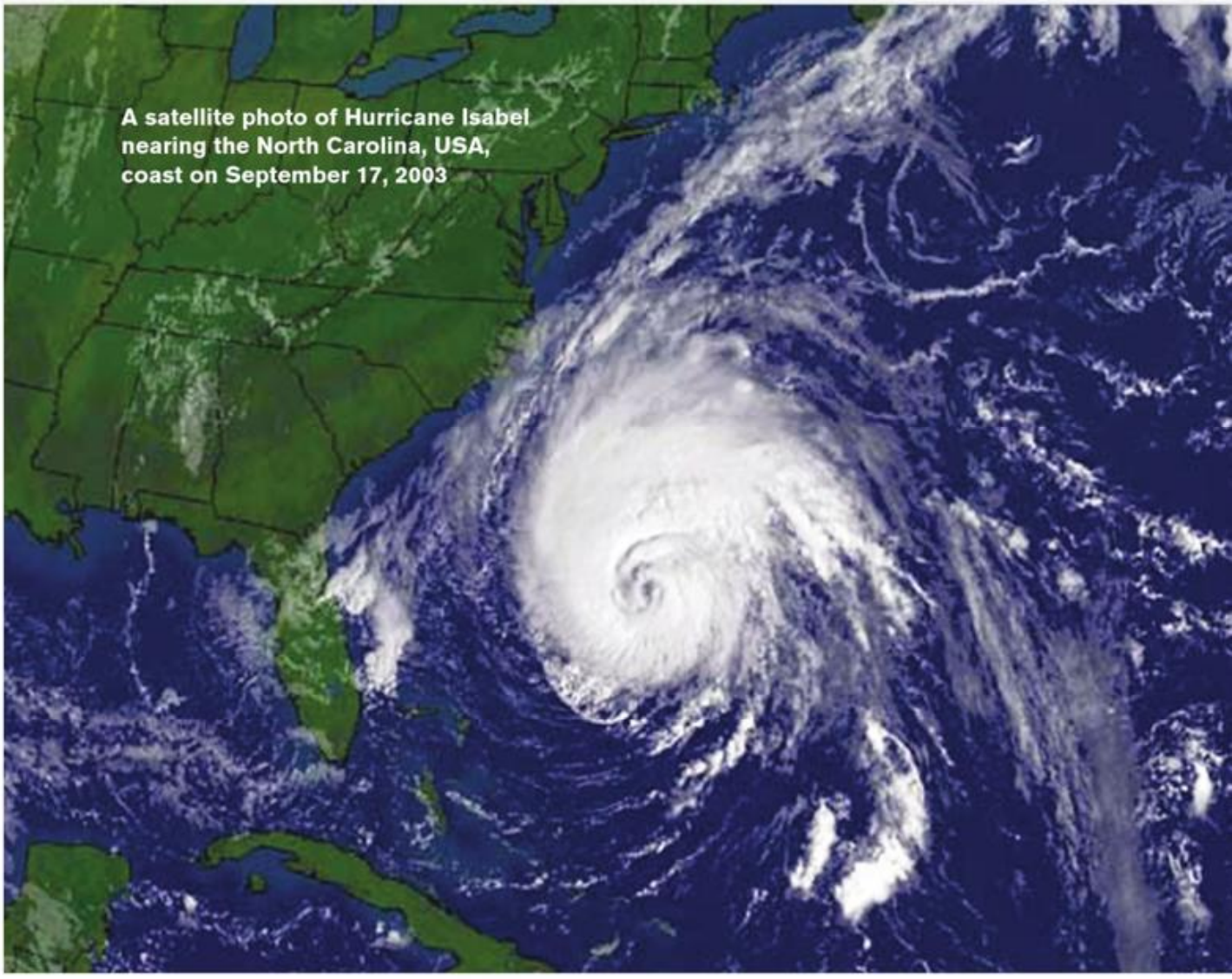
There are at least four easy ways to cook an egg. The first and probably the easiest way is to boil it. It is the easiest way because the egg is not opened. Just drop the egg into a pot of water and boil it for eight minutes. Another easy way is to scramble it. All you need is a fork to mix the egg before you put it into a hot frying pan. A third way is to fry it "over easy." Just put the egg into the pan without breaking the yellow center (the yolk). After a minute or so, turn the egg over to cook it on the other side. Finally, poaching involves cooking the egg in boiling water. Break the egg into a small metal cup that is sitting in a pan of very hot, **shallow** water. Poaching an egg takes only five minutes. Some people believe that brown eggs taste better than white eggs. _____

_____

PARAGRAPH 4.10

Different Names for the Same Kind of Storm

When bad weather, thunder, and strong winds mix, the result is a dangerous storm, but the name for that storm differs according to where the storm occurs. When a big storm forms in the Atlantic or eastern Pacific Ocean, it is called a "hurricane." This type of storm can be dangerous to people living in the United States, Mexico, Central America, or the Caribbean Islands. When a large storm begins in the southern Pacific Ocean, this same type of storm is called a "cyclone." Cyclones are less common than hurricanes **due to** the colder temperature of the water in the southern Pacific Ocean. Finally, if this same storm begins in the northwestern Pacific Ocean, it is referred to as a "typhoon." Typhoons hit areas such as Japan, Guam, or the Philippines.



A satellite photo of Hurricane Isabel nearing the North Carolina, USA, coast on September 17, 2003

5 Paragraph Review



OBJECTIVES

- Review the features of a paragraph
- Review grammar, mechanics, and punctuation
- Use articles correctly in writing
- Write a paragraph



A mother grizzly bear and her cubs stop traffic on Denali's 92-mile-long Park Road in Denali National Park, Alaska, USA.

FREEWRITE

Look at the photo and use your imagination to complete a paragraph beginning: *One day, I was driving to . . . when I saw three bears walking down the road.* Write five to ten sentences.

ELEMENTS OF GREAT WRITING

Four Features of a Good Paragraph: Review

You have learned that:

1. the first line of a paragraph is indented
2. a **paragraph** has a **topic sentence** that states the **main idea**
3. all of the sentences in the paragraph relate to the main idea
4. the **concluding sentence** ends the paragraph logically

ACTIVITY 1 | Writing topic sentences

Read the paragraphs. Write a topic sentence for each one. Remember to state the topic and include a controlling idea. Indent the first line.

WORDS TO KNOW Paragraphs 5.1 to 5.2

apply: (v) to ask for
attempt: (v) to try
former: (adj) previous
narrow: (adj) having a very small space; the opposite of wide
submit: (v) to send

PARAGRAPH 5.1

Applying to a College or University

Applicants need to know that there is a college for every student. It might be a small private college, a large state school, a community college[1], or a public university. The final choice of a school depends on students' needs and wishes. When they are ready to **apply**, students should first make a list of schools that they are interested in. If their list is long, they should shorten it to five or six. The next step is to find out the requirements for each school. Applicants should be sure to organize the correct records and information. Most applications require students to **submit** letters of recommendation[2], so students should be thinking about who will write their letters. Students can ask a **former** teacher, sports coach, or other adult to write a letter. The third step is to fill out the application for each school on their list. If an essay is required, students should do their best to make sure the language in their essay is interesting, well organized, and correct. The final step is for students to visit the schools they hope to attend. Parents often take their children to see many colleges. If applicants follow these steps, they should have a better chance of gaining admission to a school that is right for their personality and career goals.

[1]community college: a two-year college
[2]letter of recommendation: a letter written for a person applying for something

PARAGRAPH 5.2

The Amazing Capilano Bridge

It is 450 feet (137 meters) long. It is 230 feet (70 meters) above the Capilano River in British Columbia, Canada. The original wood and rope bridge was built in 1889 to help people cross the deep canyon[1]. However, today only tourists **attempt** to cross this **narrow** bridge. They simply want to enjoy the beautiful Canadian nature around the bridge. The view as you are walking across the bridge is breathtaking[2]. Without a doubt, the Capilano Bridge is an amazing place to visit.

[1]canyon: a very deep open space between two areas of land
[2]breathtaking: causing great surprise or wonder



The Capilano Bridge in Vancouver, Canada

ACTIVITY 2 | Writing supporting sentences

Read the paragraph. Then study the supporting sentences for the first and third ways to avoid a cold. Write a supporting sentence or two for the second way.

WORDS TO KNOW Paragraphs 5.3

increase: (v) to go up in number, amount **spread:** (v) move from one person to another

PARAGRAPH 5.3

How to Avoid Being Sick with a Cold

There are three ways to avoid becoming sick with a cold. The first way is to wash your hands several times during the day. Washing with soap helps kill germs[1] that can **spread** a cold from someone else to you. The second way is to eat foods that have lots of vitamin C. _____

_____

_____

Finally, a very important step to avoid getting sick is to be well rested. This means you should sleep for at least six hours every night. Being tired makes your body weaker, and this **increases** the chance of getting sick. I suggest following these simple recommendations to avoid getting a cold.

[1]germs: small living things that can cause illnesses or disease

ACTIVITY 3 | Writing concluding sentences

Look back at Paragraphs 5.1 and 5.2. Write a different concluding sentence for each paragraph. Remember that a concluding sentence can restate the main idea, make a suggestion, give an opinion, or make a prediction. Share your sentences with a partner.

Paragraph 5.1 Concluding Sentence: _____

_____

Paragraph 5.2 Concluding Sentence: _____

_____

ACTIVITY 5 | Proofreading a paragraph for comma errors

Correct the 10 comma mistakes in the student paragraph. For information on commas, see Capitalization and Punctuation in the *Writer's Handbook*.

WORDS TO KNOW Paragraph 5.6

ought to: (aux v) should
site: (n) a place; a location
spot: (n) a place; a location

PARAGRAPH 5.6

A Great Place to Visit in California

If you go to California San Diego is a great **spot** to visit, because of the many exciting things to see and do there. First you should visit the Gaslamp Quarter. In this historic area, you can easily find great food fun and culture. Next, you should visit SeaWorld to see the amazing animal shows. After you visit SeaWorld you should see a football or baseball game at Qualcomm Stadium. Finally you **ought to** see the animals at the world-famous San Diego Zoo. If you decide to go to the zoo do not forget to see the giant pandas. If you visit one two or all three of these San Diego **sites**, you will certainly have a fun and interesting trip.



A panda at the San Diego Zoo

Maintaining Paragraph Unity

It is important to be able to identify the topic, topic sentence, and writer's purpose in a paragraph. It is also important to make sure that all the supporting sentences relate to the topic sentence. Remember to refer to the controlling idea in the topic sentence to see that each supporting sentence relates to it.

ACTIVITY 15 | Combining sentences

Combine the ideas into one sentence. You may change the word forms, but do not change or omit any ideas. There may be more than one answer.

1. In this city, residents can find schools, housing, and transportation.
   The transportation is convenient.
   The schools are good, and the housing is affordable.
   The residents are new.
   The transportation is public.

   _____

   _____

2. Students can ask a former teacher to write a letter.
   Students can ask a sports coach to write a letter.
   Students can ask another adult to write a letter.
   This occurs when the students are applying for a job.

   _____

   _____

3. A shot is worth two points.
   This is a regular shot.
   A shot is worth three points.
   This is a longer shot.
   This happens in basketball.

   _____

   _____

WRITING

ACTIVITY 16 | Writing a paragraph

Write a paragraph of five to ten sentences. Follow these guidelines:

1. Write about a place that you would like to visit (but have never been to).
2. Brainstorm what you could write about this place.
3. After you have chosen your ideas for your paragraph, write a topic sentence with a controlling idea.
4. After you write your paragraph, check to see if all the supporting sentences are related to the controlling idea in the topic sentence.

5. In your concluding sentence, restate the topic, offer a suggestion, give an opinion, or make a prediction.
6. Use at least two of the vocabulary words or phrases presented in Words to Know. Underline them in your paragraph.

ACTIVITY 17 | Peer editing

Work with a partner. Read your partner's paragraph from Activity 16. Use Peer Editing Form 5 in the *Writer's Handbook*. Offer positive suggestions to help your partner write a better paragraph. Consider your partner's comments as you revise your paragraph.

Additional Topics for Writing

Here are more ideas for writing a paragraph. When you write your paragraph, follow the directions for Activity 16.

TOPIC 1: Look at the photo at the beginning of the unit. Imagine you see these bears (or other wild animals) when you are on a walk. What emotions do you experience? What do you do?

TOPIC 2: What do you think will be the highest-paying occupation 50 years from now? Give reasons to support your opinion.

TOPIC 3: What is the definition of a perfect parent? What are the characteristics of such a person?

TOPIC 4: Choose a mechanical device, such as a watch, a coffee maker, or a smartphone. How does it work? Explain the process step by step.

TOPIC 5: The United Nations was formed in 1945 to promote world peace. However, some people think that the United Nations is not useful. Do you think the United Nations is useful? Explain.

TEST PREP

TIP

Avoid information that is too general. When possible, give specific examples. Good writers want to show that they have thought about the topic, and they should aim to provide interesting and specific information in their writing. For example, a sentence like "Cookies are not healthy." does not give the reader any new information. However, a sentence like this is more informative: "Research shows that the amount of sugar in cookies and other sweet treats can create a variety of health problems."

You should spend about 25 minutes on this task. Write a paragraph with 6–10 sentences.

What are the best snack foods for busy adults who care about their health?

Be sure to include a topic sentence, one or two strong supporting reasons for each of your choices, and a solid concluding sentence. Write at least 150 words.